

PROJECT PROPOSAL PROFORMA (ANNEXURE A)

INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL OPEN UNIVERSITY

B.A. TOURISM STUDIES (BTS)

Candidate Information (to be filled by the candidate)

Date: _____

Name: _____

Programme Code: BTS Course Code: PTS-2

Enrolment No.: _____

Address: _____

Regional Centre: _____

Study Centre Name and Code: _____

Title of the Project

Marketing Strategies for Buddhist Circuit Tourism in Siliguri: A Study of Salugara and Nearby Monasteries

Synopsis / Proposal (about 400 words)

Background and Problem Statement: Siliguri has strong potential to function as a Buddhist cultural tourism gateway because of its connectivity and proximity to important monastery sites. However, promotion of Salugara and nearby monasteries remains fragmented. Many visits are incidental rather than itinerary-driven, and there is limited integrated branding, digital discoverability, and travel-trade packaging. The proposed PTS-2 study examines this marketing gap and develops a practical strategy suitable for sacred-cultural destinations.

Aim and Objectives: The aim is to design workable marketing strategies for Buddhist circuit tourism in Siliguri with focus on Salugara and nearby monasteries. The objectives are: (1) to assess current destination positioning and market visibility; (2) to identify high-potential visitor segments and their expectations; (3) to evaluate existing promotion channels, digital presence, and stakeholder coordination; (4) to apply STP and services marketing concepts for strategy design; and (5) to recommend a phased action framework with measurable indicators.

Methodology and Data Sources: The study will adopt a mixed-method marketing audit approach. Primary data will include tourist surveys, local stakeholder interactions, and semi-structured interviews with tourism-related actors. A structured digital audit will review search discoverability, map listing consistency, social media clarity, and itinerary communication. Secondary data will include policy references on Buddhist circuit development and relevant tourism statistics. Analysis will use percentage interpretation, SWOT framing, and STP logic for actionable recommendations.

Scope, Deliverables, and Work Plan: The geographic scope will be Siliguri and nearby monastery nodes linked to practical circuit development. The study will not examine internal religious administration and will remain focused on tourism marketing dimensions. The work plan covers tool preparation, field data collection, channel audit, analysis, and final report drafting. Expected deliverables include segment-specific strategy suggestions, responsible promotion guidelines, partnership pathways, and a KPI- based monitoring framework. The final report is expected to support educational evaluation as well as practical discussion on culturally sensitive destination marketing.

LETTER/CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL (By the Supervisor)

I hereby certify that the proposal for the Project entitled _____ by _____ has been prepared after due consultation with me. The proposal has my approval and has, to my knowledge, the potential of developing into a comprehensive Project Work. I also agree to supervise the above mentioned Project till its completion.

Signature of the Supervisor: _____ Name: _____ Designation: _____
Address: _____

Checklist: Keep one copy with yourself. Submit one signed proposal copy to Programme Coordinator (BTS/BAVTM), SOTHSM, IGNOU.